

Quantum information and quantum computation homework 2

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1 3SAT to SAT

Proof

We aim to prove that **3SAT** is reducible to **SAT**. The following steps outline the proof:

1. **Definition of 3SAT:** 3SAT is a restricted version of the SAT problem where each clause contains exactly three literals. For example:

$$\phi = (x_1 \vee \neg x_2 \vee x_3) \wedge (\neg x_4 \vee x_5 \vee x_6).$$

2. **Definition of SAT:** SAT is the general Boolean satisfiability problem, where each clause can have any number of literals.

3. **Goal:** To show that 3SAT is reducible to SAT, we need to transform any instance of 3SAT into an equivalent SAT formula in polynomial time.

4. **Reduction:** The transformation from 3SAT to SAT is trivial since every 3SAT formula is already in conjunctive normal form (CNF), which is a valid form for SAT. Since SAT allows clauses of any length, a formula with clauses containing exactly three literals is directly interpretable as a SAT formula without any modifications.

5. **Preservation of Satisfiability:** A 3SAT formula ϕ and its corresponding SAT formula ϕ' are identical. Therefore: - If ϕ is satisfiable in 3SAT, then ϕ' is satisfiable in SAT. - If ϕ is unsatisfiable in 3SAT, then ϕ' is unsatisfiable in SAT.

6. **Complexity:** The transformation involves no structural changes and is thus computable in linear time relative to the size of the input formula.

7. **Conclusion:** Since 3SAT is a special case of SAT, every instance of 3SAT is reducible to SAT in polynomial time.

2 SAT to 3SAT

Introduction

To prove the correctness of the reduction from SAT to 3SAT, we need to show that the transformation preserves satisfiability. Specifically, for each clause C in the original SAT formula ϕ , the replacement clauses in the 3SAT formula ϕ' are constructed such that ϕ is satisfiable if and only if ϕ' is satisfiable.

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The reduction handles clauses of different lengths separately:

- Clauses with one literal (Case 1)
- Clauses with two literals (Case 2)
- Clauses with exactly three literals (Case 3)
- Clauses with more than three literals (Case 4)

We will go through each case, explain the replacement, and prove that the satisfiability is preserved.

Case 1: Clause with One Literal

Original Clause:

Let $C = \ell$, where ℓ is a literal (either x_i or $\neg x_i$).

Replacement Clauses:

Introduce two new variables z_1 and z_2 , and replace C with the following four clauses:

$$\begin{aligned} &(\ell \vee z_1 \vee z_2), \\ &(\ell \vee \neg z_1 \vee z_2), \\ &(\ell \vee z_1 \vee \neg z_2), \\ &(\ell \vee \neg z_1 \vee \neg z_2). \end{aligned}$$

Proof of Equivalence:

The logical AND of these four clauses is equivalent to ℓ .

- If ℓ is **True**, all four clauses are **True** regardless of the values of z_1 and z_2 .
- If ℓ is **False**, we need to satisfy all clauses with $\ell = \text{False}$. The clauses become:

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{False} \vee z_1 \vee z_2), \\ &(\text{False} \vee \neg z_1 \vee z_2), \\ &(\text{False} \vee z_1 \vee \neg z_2), \\ &(\text{False} \vee \neg z_1 \vee \neg z_2). \end{aligned}$$

These clauses represent all possible combinations of z_1 and z_2 , meaning at least one clause will be **False** regardless of how z_1 and z_2 are assigned.

Conclusion: The replacement preserves satisfiability. The new formula is satisfiable if and only if the original clause ℓ is satisfiable.

Case 2: Clause with Two Literals

Original Clause:

Let $C = \ell_1 \vee \ell_2$, where ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 are literals.

Replacement Clauses:

Introduce one new variable z_1 , and replace C with the following two clauses:

$$\begin{aligned} &(\ell_1 \vee \ell_2 \vee z_1), \\ &(\ell_1 \vee \ell_2 \vee \neg z_1). \end{aligned}$$

Proof of Equivalence:

The logical AND of these two clauses is equivalent to $\ell_1 \vee \ell_2$.

- If $\ell_1 \vee \ell_2$ is **True**, both clauses are **True** regardless of z_1 .
- If $\ell_1 \vee \ell_2$ is **False**, then ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 are both **False**. The clauses become:

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{False} \vee z_1), \\ &(\text{False} \vee \neg z_1). \end{aligned}$$

This reduces to z_1 and $\neg z_1$, which cannot both be **True** simultaneously.

Conclusion: The replacement preserves satisfiability. The new formula is satisfiable if and only if the original clause C is satisfiable.

Case 3: Clause with Exactly Three Literals

Action: Leave the clause unchanged.

Conclusion: No change is necessary, and satisfiability is trivially preserved.

Case 4: Clause with More Than Three Literals**Original Clause:**

Let $C = \ell_1 \vee \ell_2 \vee \ell_3 \vee \dots \vee \ell_k$, where $k > 3$ and each ℓ_i is a literal.

Replacement Clauses:

Introduce $k - 3$ new variables $z_1, z_2, \dots, z_{k-3}$, and replace C with the following $k - 2$ clauses:

$$\begin{aligned} &(\ell_1 \vee \ell_2 \vee z_1), \\ &(\ell_3 \vee \neg z_1 \vee z_2), \\ &(\ell_4 \vee \neg z_2 \vee z_3), \\ &\quad \vdots \\ &(\ell_{k-2} \vee \neg z_{k-4} \vee z_{k-3}), \\ &(\ell_{k-1} \vee \ell_k \vee \neg z_{k-3}). \end{aligned}$$

Objective: Prove the following statements:

1. **Statement 1:** If there exists an assignment to $x_1, \dots, x_n$ such that C is **True**, then there exists an assignment to $z_1, \dots, z_{k-3}$ such that all replacement clauses are **True**.
2. **Statement 2:** If, for a given assignment to $x_1, \dots, x_n$, C is **False**, then for any assignment to $z_1, \dots, z_{k-3}$, at least one of the replacement clauses is **False**.

Proof of Statement 1:

Assumption: There exists an assignment to $x_1, \dots, x_n$ such that $C = \ell_1 \vee \ell_2 \vee \dots \vee \ell_k$ is **True**.

Objective: Find an assignment to $z_1, \dots, z_{k-3}$ such that all replacement clauses are **True**.

Proof: Since C is **True**, at least one of the literals $\ell_1, \dots, \ell_k$ is **True**.

Case A: If any of ℓ_1 or ℓ_2 is **True**.

- Then, the first clause $(\ell_1 \vee \ell_2 \vee z_1)$ is **True** regardless of z_1 .
- Assign z_1 arbitrarily.
- Proceed recursively with the rest of the clauses.

Case B: If ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 are **False**, but ℓ_i is **True** for some $i \geq 3$.

Let j be the smallest index ≥ 3 such that ℓ_j is **True**.

Assign $z_1, z_2, \dots, z_{j-3}$ such that:

- For $t = 1$ to $j - 3$, set $z_t = \text{False}$.
- This makes $\neg z_{t-1} = \text{True}$ (for $t \geq 2$), satisfying the clauses.

The clause $(\ell_j \vee \neg z_{j-3} \vee z_{j-2})$ (if $j < k$) or $(\ell_{k-1} \vee \ell_k \vee \neg z_{k-3})$ (if $j = k$) will be satisfied because ℓ_j is **True**. For $t = j - 2$ to $k - 3$, assign z_t arbitrarily (if any).

Example for Clarity

Suppose $k = 6$, literals are $\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3, \ell_4, \ell_5, \ell_6$.

Suppose ℓ_4 is **True**, and ℓ_1, ℓ_2, ℓ_3 are **False**.

- Assign $z_1 = \text{False}$, so $\neg z_1 = \text{True}$.
- The second clause $(\ell_3 \vee \neg z_1 \vee z_2)$ is satisfied since $\neg z_1 = \text{True}$.
- Assign $z_2 = \text{False}$, so $\neg z_2 = \text{True}$.
- The third clause $(\ell_4 \vee \neg z_2 \vee z_3)$ is satisfied because $\ell_4 = \text{True}$.

Conclusion: By appropriately assigning z_i , we can ensure all clauses are **True** when C is **True**.

Proof of Statement 2

Since C is **False**, all ℓ_i are **False**.

We will show that the clauses form a chain of dependencies that cannot be satisfied when all ℓ_i are **False**.

- **First Clause:** $(\ell_1 \vee \ell_2 \vee z_1)$
 - Since ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 are **False**, the clause reduces to (z_1) .
- **Second Clause:** $(\ell_3 \vee \neg z_1 \vee z_2)$
 - Since ℓ_3 is **False**, the clause reduces to $(\neg z_1 \vee z_2)$.
- **Third Clause:** $(\ell_4 \vee \neg z_2 \vee z_3)$
 - Since ℓ_4 is **False**, the clause reduces to $(\neg z_2 \vee z_3)$.
- $\vdots$
- **Last Clause:** $(\ell_{k-1} \vee \ell_k \vee \neg z_{k-3})$
 - Since ℓ_{k-1} and ℓ_k are **False**, the clause reduces to $(\neg z_{k-3})$.

Now, we can derive a contradiction:

- From the first clause, z_1 must be **True**.
- From the second clause, since $z_1 = \text{True}$, $\neg z_1 = \text{False}$, so z_2 must be **True**.
- From the third clause, $z_2 = \text{True}$ implies $\neg z_2 = \text{False}$, so z_3 must be **True**.
- Continue this pattern up to z_{k-3} .
- From the last clause, $\neg z_{k-3}$ must be **True**, so z_{k-3} must be **False**.

Contradiction: $z_{k-3} = \text{True}$ and $z_{k-3} = \text{False}$.

Conclusion: It's impossible to assign values to $z_1, \dots, z_{k-3}$ to satisfy all clauses when all ℓ_i are **False**. Therefore, the conjunction of the replacement clauses is **False**.

Overall Conclusion

The reduction from SAT to 3SAT preserves satisfiability for each clause:

- If a clause C is **True** under some assignment, the replacement clauses can be satisfied by extending the assignment to the new variables.
- If a clause C is **False** under some assignment, the replacement clauses cannot be satisfied, regardless of how the new variables are assigned.

By applying this transformation to each clause in ϕ , we ensure that the overall formula ϕ' is satisfiable if and only if ϕ is satisfiable.

Now the proof is completed. $\square$